

GUIDELINES FOR THE SACRAMENT OF MATRIMONY IN OUR PARISH

A. Before Marriage

Couples intending to marry should approach the Parish Office well in advance.

All couples intending to marry should register at the Parish Office during the month of June, or within the period announced by the parish.

Both parties must participate in the prescribed marriage preparation programme.

The Diocese of Vasai conducts a two-day marriage preparation programme at Atmashodh. Couples are expected to attend this programme as required.

With the assistance of the Family Commission, the parish will conduct additional marriage preparation sessions during July, August and September, according to the parish schedule.

The priest shall conduct the required canonical enquiry/investigation before the marriage.

Candidates should approach their respective priest for the PNF (Pre-Nuptial Form) and complete all required procedures.

The couple must submit the required Baptismal Certificates and other documents.

All government documents should contain the same and correct details, particularly names, dates of birth and other personal information.

Any error or discrepancy in government or Church documents must be corrected before the Nuptial Mass.

The required announcements/banns shall be made according to the norms of the Diocese of Vasai and the Catholic Church.

The priest must establish that both parties are free and properly disposed to enter into marriage according to Church law.

B. Celebration of Marriage

The approved Rite of Marriage shall be followed.

At least two witnesses are required according to the requirements of the Church.

The witnesses should be informed in advance and should be present for the Nuptial Mass/celebration.

The celebration shall take place according to the regulations of the Catholic Church and the Diocese of Vasai.

Music, decorations, photography and video recording must respect the sacredness and dignity of the church and liturgy.

The couple, family members and guests are expected to maintain appropriate decorum and reverence throughout the celebration.

C. After the Nuptial Mass

After the Nuptial Mass, the couple and their family members are requested to maintain silence and preserve the sacred atmosphere of the church.

Congregational movement, loud conversations, photography or other activities should not disturb those who may wish to pray.

The marriage should be properly entered into the Parish Marriage Register and other required ecclesiastical records.

The newly married couple is encouraged to continue participating actively in Sunday Eucharist, parish life and Christian family formation.